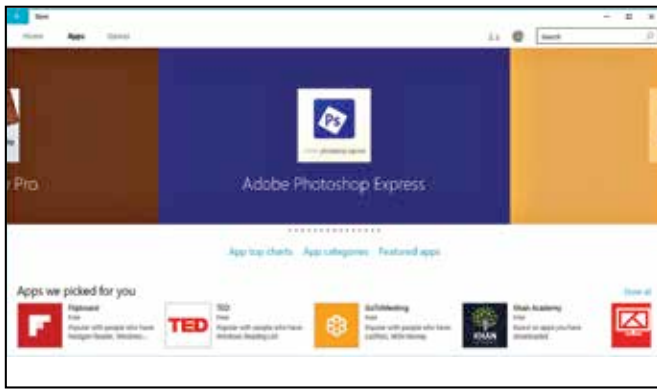




The Windows 10 store now offers Apps, Music and Videos though a single storefront. Of course we wouldn't know because only Apps are available in India.



Microsoft is dreaming big, and aiming to reach a billion devices over the next 2-3 years. Cross-platform bridges are one of their efforts to enable that.

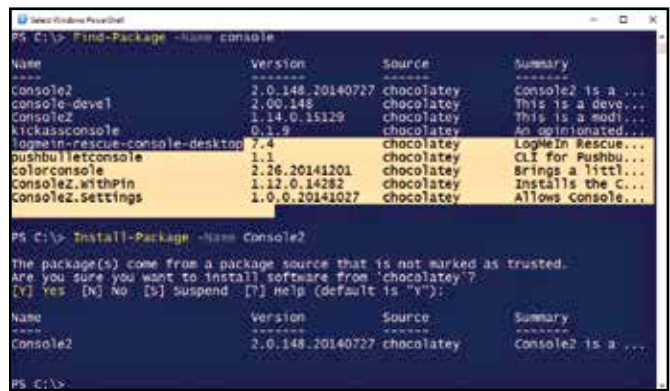
now .NET applications can be compiled to native machine code. Performance isn't even the only advantage of .NET Native, unlike previous .NET applications that needed to have the .NET Framework used by the app installed on the end-user's machine, compiled applications are self-contained and can ship with the bits of .NET that they need to run. This means you can use the latest version of .NET without worrying about packaging the huge .NET installer with your app.

OneGet: If you've used Linux you'll notice that the ease of getting and installing applications on it is unparalleled. If you want a package available for your OS, installing it is just an 'apt-get', 'zypper', 'yum', or 'pacman' command away. Windows 10 ships with a similar tool called OneGet (which can be installed on previous Windows versions as well). With OneGet you get PowerShell commands such as 'Find-Package' for searching for packages to install, and 'Install-Package' to install them. It automatically downloads the package and extracts / installs it while creating a convenient launch script. It uses the popular community-run Chocolatey service and package in for most of the work and acts as a sort for meta-package-manager that can be extended with support for other installers / package managers.

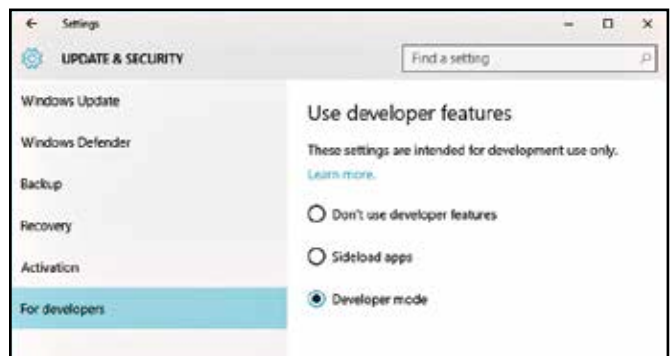
Console Improvements: Microsoft's cmd.exe command shell is quite, quite bad, and hasn't improved much in a long time.

Finally, with Windows 10 Microsoft has put in some work to make the experience of using 'cmd.exe' better.

First of all, finally you can resize the console window just like any other window by dragging the edges. What's more this will automatically cause text to wrap if possible. Another great addition is the ability to easily select text in a console window without needing to access a submenu of the window menu to go into mark mode. Selecting text



Here you can see the new Find-Package and Install-Package commands in action in the new Windows 10 console. Also you can see the new line-by-line selection feature in action. How efficient of us.



No need for obscure registry hacks or shady patcher, Windows 10 can sideload apps or be put in developer mode through the control panel.

in the console window now works like every other window that lists text, i.e. text is selected line-by-line rather than whatever comes inside the rectangle you draw on screen. You can also do this with usual keyboard shortcuts, just press the shift and cursor keys to extend your selection and use Ctrl-C to copy and Ctrl-V to paste.

The console is now also HiDPI aware and as such won't need a magnifying glass to view on such screens. Also, you can now make the console window semi-transparent just like them people do on their Linuxes!

Conclusion

The road to a converged Windows hasn't been without its bumps –with one of those major bumps being the massively ill-thought Windows 8 – and Windows 10 is still fresh. There are surely bumps yet to come as Microsoft seems to be trying everything new all at once. It is unlikely that the Windows 10 launch will be without niggles, but Microsoft does seem to have at least some measures in place to alleviate those issues.

We have peer-to-peer downloading of updates to reduce the burden and increase performance of frequent update downloads; the promise of frequent updates in the first place to get not only fixes, but also new features out quicker. Of course there is Windows Insider, Microsoft's constant pool of beta-testers using the future versions of their OS and giving feedback. With such massive changes to the Windows ecosystem, how the chips fall will only become clear perhaps a decade from now when we can compare where Windows 10 is (or whatever it's called by then) compared to now, and compared to 10 years ago when Windows XP was still the latest Microsoft OS. >